

Halden Institute — Internal Memorandum

To: Research staff **From:** Office of the Director **Subject:** Partnership review and instrument standards

Partnership review

The Institute's partnership with Meridian on the Kepler Initiative has been reviewed and the Director recommends continuing it through the programme's fifth year. Kepler remains the Institute's largest external collaboration.

Dr. Ingrid Halvorsen will continue as the Institute's co-chair. Staff should route programme correspondence through her office rather than contacting Meridian's Lisbon office directly.

A note on history

Several staff have asked about the Institute's earlier connection to Meridian Labs. Dr. Amara Okonkwo led the Institute's sensor group before leaving to direct Meridian in 2021. The working relationship between the two organisations predates the Kepler Initiative by some years, and the Institute holds a non-exclusive licence to the Wavelet platform as a result.

Instrument standards

Following the salinity drift reported by the Kepler team, the Institute is adopting an annual recalibration requirement for all buoy-mounted instruments, not only Wavelet units. Tomas Ferreira has agreed to chair the working group drafting the standard.

The Institute will also begin logging calibration history centrally. Priya Raghunathan has offered to share Meridian's calibration tooling, which the working group is evaluating.

Budget note

The Nordic Marine Council grant that funds the Institute's share of Kepler is up for renewal. The Office of the Director expects a decision within the year. Staff should not assume continuity of funding for programme-dependent work beyond the current cycle.